

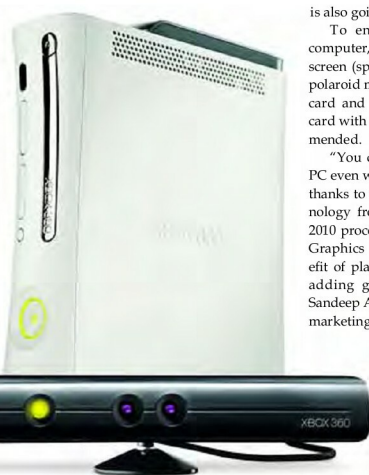
device, 3-DS, but it's not available right now. The technology behind the 3-DS requires viewers to sit at a certain angle and distance from the screen.

The latest PlayStation from Sony, PS3, has all the features to play 3-D games. Through a firmware, all existing PS3s can be upgraded to 3-D. This firmware is available on the PlayStation website (playstation.com) free of charge. You'll need a 3-D TV and 3-D glasses along with PS3 to enjoy 3-D gaming.

Compared to earlier versions (PS2 and PSP handheld), PS3 is a top-level version that's way beyond a gaming console. It becomes a central playback device in your house that can play Blu-ray movies and DVDs, and has built-in Wi-Fi and a large storage space for games, movies, music, videos and photos. Its built-in Blu-ray player shows HD movies at 1080p.

PS3 costs about Rs 19,990. But, "it's a value-for-money device as it features Blu-ray playback, HD gaming, 120GB hard disk space, Net compatibility, capability of playing photos and music and showing on TV. Also, one PS3 can talk to another PS3 and share the game. Add to that 3-D compatibility," says Atindriya Bose, country manager-PlayStation, Sony Computer Entertainment Europe.

Microsoft's Xbox 360 is also 3-D-capable and 3-D games for the system are available today. Jaspreet Bindra, regional director, entertainment and devices division, Microsoft Corporation (India), says, "While others focus their efforts on 3-D as the market evolves, Microsoft is more excited about growth and innovation potential of controller-free games and entertainment—an experience you can get only on Xbox 360. Kinect will add value to the future of 3-D gaming by making it



Microsoft Xbox 360

more interactive and fun."

The Kinect's motion-sensing technology for Xbox 360 dispenses with the handheld and instead makes you the controller. It senses your movements, your gestures as well as voice and changes the way you play and experience entertainment.

The Kinect sensor is claimed to be the world's first to combine an RGB camera, depth sensor, multi-array microphone and custom processor running proprietary software all in one device. Unlike 2-D cameras and controllers, Kinect tracks your full body movement in 3-D, while responding to commands, directions, even a difference of emotion in your voice. Kinect will let you play driving games, for example, by simply moving your hands as if turning a car's steering wheel.

3-D gaming computers

PCs from OEMs like Dell, Acer and ASUS support 3-D technology. Lenovo

is also going to launch 3-D models.

To enjoy 3-D gaming on a computer, you need a 3-D-enabled screen (specially coated with some polaroid material), a good graphics card and 3-D glasses. A graphics card with dedicated 1 GB is recommended.

"You can play 3-D games on a PC even without the graphics card, thanks to the latest processor technology from Intel. The Intel Core 2010 processors based on Intel HD Graphics offer the user the benefit of playing 3-D games without adding graphics card," informs Sandeep Aurora, director, sales and marketing group-South Asia, Intel.

A 3-D-compliant PC also has a much more powerful processor. The monitor has a much higher refresh rate; while regular monitors will have a refresh rate of 60 Hz, the Dell Alienware monitors for 3-D gaming have a refresh rate of 120 Hz. This works with the graphics card to throw up two sets of images, which are processed by the human eye into 3-D images using 3-D glasses. None of this is possible on a regular PC.

You can also make your existing PC 3-D-compliant provided it has a powerful enough processor like the i7. "To rig your home PC for 3-D, you need NVIDIA 3-D Vision, a compatible graphics card, 3-D Vision-ready monitor and a supporting operating system. But I am quite sure that with the rapid technological advances, soon you will not require to change your PC configuration to make it 3-D compatible. 3-D vision will be achieved with minor changes in your existing PC," says Huang.

"The Nvidia GeForce graphics card is specially programmed to render and displays two images, one for your left eye and the other for your right eye. The monitor and 3-D glasses work with the graphics card, so each eye